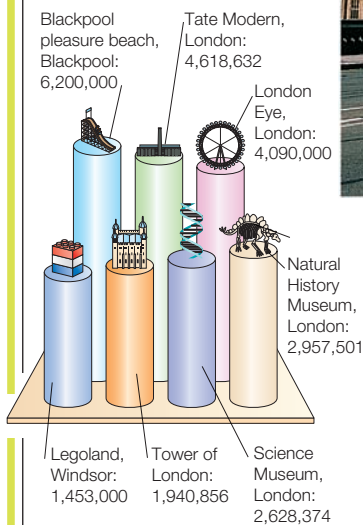




UNITED KINGDOM

UNITED KINGDOM**Capital city:** London**Area:** 94,525 sq miles
(244,820 sq km)**Population:** 59,300,000**Official language:** English**Major religions:** Christian
60%, Muslim 3%, Hindu
1%, other 36%**Government:** Multiparty
democracy**Currency:** Pound sterling**Adult literacy rate:** 99%**Life expectancy:** 77 years**People per doctor:** 500**Televisions:** 645 per 1,000
people**Visitor numbers to 7 of
the top UK tourist sites****HOMES**

Many people in the UK live in suburbs on the outskirts of towns and cities. Suburbs offer a cleaner environment, more space, and transportation links, making commuting to jobs in city centers possible. British life is closely centered on the home. Houses tend to be more popular than apartments, and home improvement work and gardening are popular leisure activities.

Where people live

90% live in the city.

10% in the country.

UNITED KINGDOM

FOR A SMALL COUNTRY, the United Kingdom (UK) has had a huge influence on world affairs. At one time it controlled a vast empire, which is why English is now spoken across the globe. The Industrial Revolution of the late 1700s, which brought large-scale factory production, began here, then spread worldwide. Today, many of the UK's traditional industries have declined. This highly urban society is now more reliant on service industries, such as banking and insurance, while huge reserves of oil in the North Sea meet much of its energy needs.

Red London buses rush past the Houses of Parliament, home of the United Kingdom's government.

**LONDON**

Founded by the Romans in AD 43, London is now a city of 7 million people and is one of the largest cities in Europe. The capital is one of the world's leading centers of culture, finance, and tourism. Each year millions of people visit London to sample its theaters, museums, and historic buildings. Tourism is now a major industry throughout the whole of the UK. Places such as the west coast of Scotland and the historic cities of Bath and York, attract thousands of tourists.

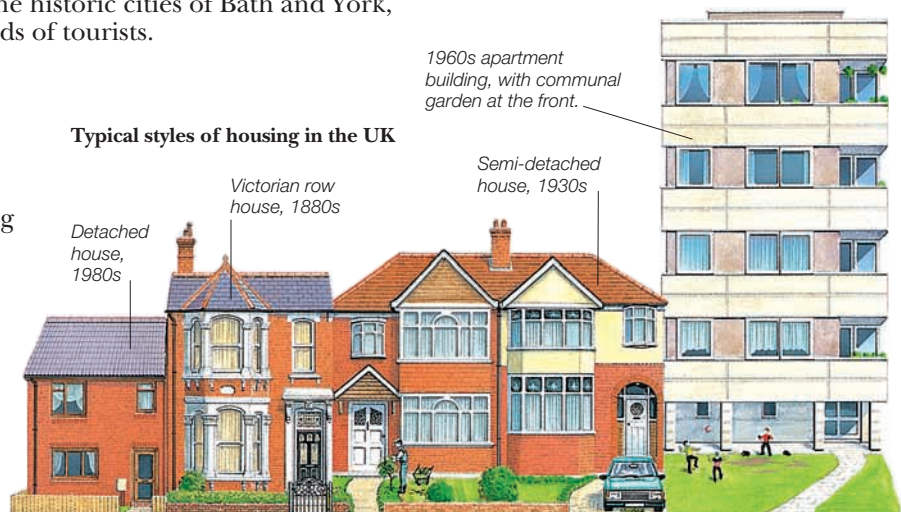
**A MULTICULTURAL SOCIETY**

Since the 1950s, the UK has become an increasingly multicultural society. Large numbers of people from the UK's former colonies in Africa, the West Indies, and the Indian Subcontinent have made their home here, establishing their own distinctive communities and enriching British life with their culture and traditions.

EDINBURGH

The beautiful city of Edinburgh lies on the chilly east coast of Scotland. Perched on a hill, Edinburgh Castle looks out over a city of winding medieval streets and splendid Georgian townhouses. The city is home to a major international arts festival held every summer.

Street performers at the Edinburgh Festival

**Typical styles of housing in the UK**

1960s apartment building, with communal garden at the front.

Semi-detached house, 1930s

Victorian row house, 1880s

Detached house, 1980s